

# How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next. There is no single path to getting involved.

## Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge, and voice are essential. Join the community consultation process and help shape the design of what is built here.

## Forestry & Energy Professionals

Technical review, feasibility input, and partnership in implementation of forest restoration and energy systems.

## Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early community outreach. Impact-first approach.

## Researchers & Academics

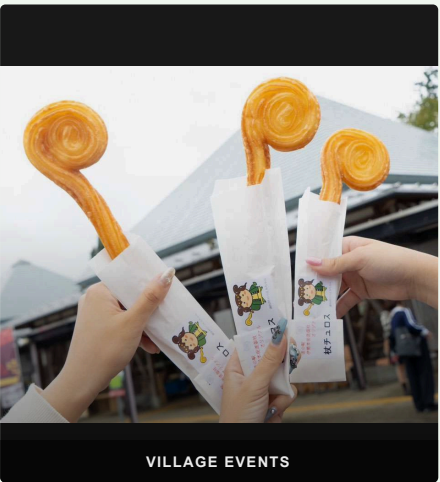
Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, rural energy modelling, and ecological monitoring.

## Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village facing the same challenges to replicate and adapt.



JINJA FESTIVAL



VILLAGE EVENTS

Mitsue.  
ECOLOGY · ENERGY · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE



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Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan  
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# THE MITSUE PROJECT

Ecology · Energy  
Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

MITSUE VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

## Three Pillars

### Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture replaced with native mixed forest, healing land that has been ecologically depleted for decades. Landowners begin receiving income from timber harvest from Year 2.

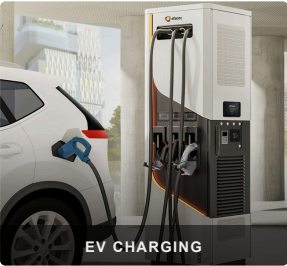
### Biomass CHP & Energy Resilience

Sugi forest thinnings fuel a biomass CHP system providing electricity (primary) and heat (secondary) — the forest powers the village. Solar panels and EV charging for residents and visitors complement the system, with blackout resilience built in.

### Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside the Mitsue Taiken Koryukan, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating local employment and stable long-term revenue where none existed before. Phase 2 expands to a larger old factory in Mitsue.

*"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."*



## What We're Building

The Mitsue Taiken Koryukan and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency for Japan and the world.

### WHY THIS PLACE?

- ✓ Taiken Koryukan available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots since 2012
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas
- ✓ Advances Mitsue Village's official Renewable Energy Plan (2025)
- ✓ Proven open-data ethos from Safecast

### FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO biomass & rural energy grants · 御杖村 地域脱炭素移行 · 再エネ推進交付金 (via village) · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff revenues · J-Credit carbon offset income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

### ADVISORS

- Joi Ito** — President, Chiba Institute of Technology
- Ray Ozzie** — Executive Chair, Blues
- Takuo Dome** — Professor Emeritus, Osaka University · Director, Inochi Forum
- San Poisson** — Project Manager

## Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits for results.

|           |                                                                                                  |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Year 1    | Taiken Koryukan reactivated as datacenter hub; international media visibility for Mitsue Village |
| Year 2    | Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest                                             |
| Year 3–4  | Biomass CHP unit & EV charging stations operational; battery storage for blackout resilience     |
| Year 4–5  | Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance created                          |
| Year 5–10 | Data service revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes                               |
| Year 25   | Native mixed forest established; model fully documented and shared openly worldwide              |

### About the Team

**Rob Oudendijk** — Dutch electrical engineer, resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million radiation measurements published openly since 2011.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.

